

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Pooja Gupta

Address: 1 Holland Avenue Cheam SM2 6HW

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to formally object to the proposed change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Place of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub), including the proposed extensions and increase in height.

While I appreciate the value of community facilities, this proposal raises several significant concerns.

1. School Safety: The proposed use would invite many people and strangers to visit nearby areas of the Avenue Primary school and there will be risk of school children getting exposed to strangers and unknown people. Recently there are communications from School reporting the incidents in Sutton, pupils are being followed and stalked by random people, thereby increasing the risks of incidents against school pupil. Children safety should be of priority.

2. Increased traffic, Parking and Road Safety: The proposed use is likely to generate substantially higher visitor numbers, particularly during evenings and weekends. The area already suffers from limited on-street parking, and there is insufficient evidence that the site can accommodate peak demand. Overspill parking would likely cause congestion, obstruct driveways and junctions, and compromise access for emergency vehicles.

3. We truly acknowledge the feelings of the muslim community to have their regular prayers. It is to be noteworthy that this area is already have multiple mosques (in Sutton) and big mosque in Morden.

Following are couple of mosques and Islamic Centres within 5 miles of the proposed property-

1) Sutton Central Masjid, 25 Carshalton Rd, Sutton SM1 4LF. 1.8 miles

2) Sutton Islamic Centre, 62 Oakhill Rd, Sutton SM1 3AG. 2.6 miles

3) Muslim Cultural & Welfare Association of Sutton (MCWAS), Wentworth Hall, 80 Ruskin Rd, Carshalton SM5 3DH. 3.2 miles

4) The Baitul Futuh Mosque, 181 London Rd, Morden SM4 5PT. (Biggest mosque in London). 4.4 miles

5) Morden Islamic Community Centre, 116 London Rd, Morden SM4 5AX. 4.6 miles

These mosque and centre should serve the community and the followers to conduct prayers and other activities.

4. Noise and Residential Amenity: Religious services, meetings, events, and gatherings are likely to generate ongoing noise, particularly in the evenings and at weekends. The application lacks sufficient detail regarding operating hours, capacity limits, and noise mitigation measures to safeguard neighbouring amenity.

In summary, the proposal represents a material intensification of use that would adversely affect parking, highway and pedestrian safety, residential amenity, and the character of this predominantly residential area. I therefore respectfully request that the application be refused.